

tions compared to the previously recorded image is transmitted to the OS. A dedicated light emitting diode (LED) is used to illuminate the surface to make detection easier. Since the camera scans the surface for changes, its task is made difficult if the surface is devoid of any distinguishing pattern or is highly reflective.

3.6.6 Refresh Rate

Refresh rate is the number of images taken by the optical sensor of a mouse. This is variable and usually in the hundreds per second. A higher figure means a quicker response.

3.6.7 Scroll Wheel

This is the wheel found in between the main two mouse buttons, and can be used to scroll through a document. This is the default behaviour as set by the default driver. The mouse driver can be used to allocate a different function for the wheel.

3.6.8 Trackball

This is seen on some mice as a freely moving sphere that can be used to more accurately position the cursor on the screen.



A classic trackball mouse

3.6.9 Wireless Mouse

This mouse does away with the need for wires by using radio waves to communicate with a base station that is connected by wires to the system, usually to the USB port. The mouse has an independent power source, usually in the form of batteries, or can be recharged by plugging into the base station. Since radio waves can pass through objects, there is no need to position the mouse in front of the base station to use it.



Wireless mice give you a lot of freedom